

The Living Age — SFL Impact Project

Proposal

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Project Name

The Living Age: Connecting Biology, Technology, and the Philosophy of Liberty

One-Line Summary

A cross-disciplinary impact project that uses biological science and creative media to demonstrate that decentralized, voluntary order is not just a political ideal — it is how life itself works.

The Problem

The liberty movement loses its most capable people because it frames freedom as a political argument instead of a creative endeavor. Engineers, biologists, designers, and builders leave because they are creators, not politicians. They don't want to fight the machine — they want to grow something that makes it irrelevant.

Meanwhile, the strongest empirical case for voluntary order sits untouched in the sciences. Every biology student already knows that centralized control in the body is called cancer. Every ecology student knows that monoculture plantations collapse while diverse forests endure for millennia. Every bioinformatics student works with systems where trillions of actors coordinate without a central

planner. They already understand emergent order — they just haven't connected it to political philosophy.

The liberty movement has a language problem. It speaks in politics to people who think in systems. The Living Age bridges that gap.

The Solution

The Living Age is an impact project with two arms:

1. Media — Explain Why

A content platform (YouTube, written essays, event recordings) that presents the case for voluntary order through the lens of biology, not ideology.

Core content themes: - **"37 Trillion Cells, No Government"** — How your body coordinates trillions of actors without central planning - **"Cancer Is Central Planning"** — What happens when one cell overrides the cooperative system and demands all resources flow to itself - **"The Open Source Economy of the Cell"** — How life runs a decentralized economy with no debt, no intellectual property, and no rent-seeking — for four billion years without a crash - **"The Spiral and the Block"** — Two models of order across every scale: Fibonacci spirals (living, resilient, emergent) vs. grid blocks (rigid, brittle, imposed)

This is not metaphor. This is peer-reviewed biology reframed in the language of Hayek, Mises, and spontaneous order. The data comes from STRING protein-protein interaction networks, RegulonDB gene regulatory networks, KEGG metabolic pathways, and single-cell RNA sequencing.

2. Technology — Show How

A bioinformatics toolkit (genome analysis, protein interaction mapping, living systems design) that demonstrates voluntary order is not only natural but designable. Built on real APIs: UCSC Genome Browser, NCBI Entrez, ESM-3 protein language models, AlphaFold.

The science is deeper than metaphor. James Shapiro's work on natural genetic engineering (Shapiro, 2005) shows that genomes don't evolve through random

character-by-character mutation — they restructure themselves by rearranging existing functional modules in new combinations, activated by stress, regulated by the cell itself. The genome operates like a decentralized ledger: no central controller, distributed consensus across cells, self-rewriting protocols, and fork events that create new species the way a blockchain hard fork creates a new chain. Bret Weinstein's work on lineage selection and telomeric dynamics reinforces the same principle from the ecological side — organisms are stewards of genomes, not owners, and selection operates across multiple levels, not just the selfish gene. Life doesn't wait for a central authority to approve a mutation. It engineers its own adaptation from the bottom up.

The technology arm proves that the distributed, entrepreneurial components of biology — local, adaptive, signal-responsive — are the designable ones. The centralized, hub-dependent components are brittle. This is the data that makes the philosophical argument undeniable.

Why SFL

Students For Liberty is uniquely positioned to host this project because:

1. **Cross-campus reach.** The Living Age needs to connect biology students, engineering students, philosophy students, and economics students across California and beyond. SFL's campus network is the mycelium that connects these roots.
2. **Interdisciplinary credibility.** SFL events framed as "Is Nature Libertarian?" or "How Does a Forest Think?" draw audiences that would never attend a political meeting. The science framing opens doors that ideology closes. Liberty students already know Bret Weinstein from DarkHorse Podcast — his work on evolutionary stewardship and emergent order is a familiar entry point into the deeper biology. The Living Age takes that intuition and gives it molecular evidence.
3. **Pipeline for builders.** SFL campuses are full of students who hold libertarian values but see no path from their STEM degree to meaningful liberty-aligned work. The Living Age gives them one — bioengineering, regenerative systems, open-source tools, decentralized technology. Not

everyone who resonates with liberty wants to go into politics. Most of them want to make things.

4. **Content that compounds.** Every Socratic event, every campus conversation, every connection between biology and philosophy becomes content for the Living Age platform — building a permanent, growing body of evidence that liberty isn't a political position, it's how life works.

Activities and Deliverables

Campus Events — Socratic Conversations

Format: "Is Nature Libertarian? What Biology Reveals About How Order Actually Works" - 45-minute interdisciplinary talk + 30-minute open discussion - Walk through three scales of evidence: molecular (protein networks), cellular (your body as a society), ecological (the forest economy) - End with a question, not a conclusion — let the audience draw their own implications - Partner with biology clubs, philosophy departments, econ societies

Target: 3-5 events across California campuses in the first cycle, expanding to other states through SFL's network.

Content Production

Deliverable	Timeline	Platform
"Is Nature Libertarian?" recorded talk	Month 2	YouTube / SFL channels
"The Open Source Economy of the Cell" essay	Month 1	SFL blog / Living Age site
PPI network visualization walkthrough	Month 3	YouTube
"Cancer Is Central Planning" short-form video	Month 2	Instagram / TikTok / SFL social
Campus event highlight reels	Ongoing	All platforms

Network Building

- Identify and connect libertarian-minded STEM students across California campuses
- Build a lateral network of students working at the intersection of biology, technology, and liberty
- Connect students to meaningful work: bioengineering, regenerative agriculture, open-source biotech, decentralized systems
- Cross-pollinate with conferences: SynBioBeta, FreedomFest, LibertyCon, ISFLC

Open-Source Tools

- Publish bioinformatics notebooks demonstrating decentralized order in real biological data
- Make all code, visualizations, and analysis publicly available
- Create templates for other SFL chapters to run their own "Is Nature Libertarian?" events

Measurable Impact

Metric	6-Month Target
Campus events hosted	5+
Unique event attendees	200+
YouTube/content views	5,000+
STEM students connected to liberty-aligned work or networks	25+
SFL chapters adopting the Socratic event format	3+ outside California
Published essays / content pieces	10+
Open-source tools released	2+

Beyond the First Cycle

The Living Age is designed to outlast any single funding period. Event templates are replicable — any SFL chapter can run "Is Nature Libertarian?" with the materials we publish. The content compounds: every essay, video, and visualization becomes a permanent resource. The mycelium network of STEM-liberty students, once connected, sustains itself laterally. The first cycle plants the roots. The network grows from there.

What Makes This Different

Most liberty movement content argues *against* something. The Living Age argues *from* something — from the evidence that life itself is organized on voluntary, decentralized principles.

This is not ideology projected onto nature. This is nature revealing the principle that the liberty movement has been arguing about in the wrong language for decades.

The shift: - From **"government is bad"** to **"how does a forest organize itself without a manager?"** - From **political debates** to **interdisciplinary discovery** - From **recruiting libertarians** to **connecting people who already think in systems** - From **arguments against the state** to **evidence from life itself**

The people who walk away saying "I've never heard it put that way" are worth more than a hundred sign-ups who forget by Tuesday. Seeds, not pamphlets. Spirals, not blocks.

About the Project Lead

Sage Arthur Jordan Clokey — SFL State Director for California. Graduating with a B.S. in Bioinformatics from UC Santa Cruz (Spring 2026). Grandson of Art Clokey, the creator of Gumby — a man who showed the world that clay could come alive. The inheritance is not the character but the ability to create stories and tools that awaken imagination. Clay to code. Story to system.

Previously served as Young Americans for Liberty State Chair for California. Attended SynBioBeta 2026 and connected with synthetic biologists — including Drew Endy (Hoover Institution) — on how to do synthetic biology in ways aligned with voluntary principles. The overlap between decentralized biology and libertarian philosophy is natural. These people already think in emergent systems. They just need the philosophical language, and we need their technical language.

The Living Age is the convergence: media that explains why voluntary order works, and technology that shows how to design with it.

Budget Request

Item	Cost	Notes
Campus event materials (printing, flyers, handouts)	\$300	For 5 events
Travel to partner campuses	\$500	Mileage + lodging for SoCal/Bay Area events
Recording equipment (portable mic + camera)	\$400	For documenting events as content
Web hosting and domain	\$100	Living Age platform
Conference registration (FreedomFest / LibertyCon)	\$200	Cross-pollination and networking
Total	\$1,500	

All technology tools (bioinformatics software, APIs, analysis platforms) are open-source or free-tier. Content production uses existing equipment. This is a high-impact, low-cost project by design.

The Ask

Approve The Living Age as an official SFL Impact Project. Provide the platform, the network, and the modest funding above. In return, SFL gets:

- A new category of content that reaches STEM students the movement has never spoken to
 - A replicable event format any chapter can adopt
 - Open-source tools and visualizations that make the case for liberty from the hardest evidence there is — biology itself
 - A State Director whose campus work and impact project reinforce each other in a single spiral
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The creation of the Living Age requires media to explain why and technology to show how. Life is the proof. The spiral is the method. The Living Age is the name.

*Sage Arthur Jordan Clokey State Director, Students For Liberty — California
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